Worlds we can inhabit

A future where belonging is secure, life takes many forms, and what we build can become something else.

A worldbuilding project by Ren, developed with AI





01 / AN ORDINARY DAY

Your place here is already yours.

You wake in a home opening onto a garden. Breakfast is available at the neighborhood kitchen. You can join a table, carry a cup outside, or stay home.

Along the path, someone is tending a patch of moss. Children are testing a floating path. A neighbor who once organized everything now spends long afternoons reading. Her home remains hers to inhabit.

The city is a garden with rooms inside it: places for friendship, solitude, care, invention, and seasons. Machines maintain the systems that keep it livable. Residents can take part because they want to.

You have no plan for today. You still belong.

What makes this possible?

Imagine autonomous intelligence and robots reliably operating enough of the industrial network to provide and maintain the means of living. Some machines help build factories that make more machines.

01

A technological premise

We grant this capability to explore a possible future. This project does not establish complete autonomy today or predict an arrival date.

02

A durable material claim

Everyone can access housing, food, care, learning, and creative tools. The claim survives unemployment, unpopularity, and disagreement with those administering the system.

03

A meaningful way to leave

People can leave a community without losing their means of living. Communities can challenge the systems serving them.

Productive capacity and the right to share in it have to be built together.



03 / OPEN UNIVERSITY

Many ways to spend a life.

At the Open University, a question about the sea can become an afternoon of observation or a project lasting years. You can learn an instrument, study perception, leave, return, and begin again. Understanding changes what you notice.

Elsewhere, people gather around dance, sensation, costume, and music. Exploration communities build observatories and imagine journeys beyond Earth. Gardeners devote themselves to a small piece of ground.

These lives overlap. You can be absorbed in astronomy for a season and friendship for the next. Some people have no great project. They cook, swim, fall in love, watch the weather. A generous civilization makes room for them too.

Belonging never requires an impressive answer to what you are becoming.



04 / HOUSE OF WORLDS

Realities we make together.

Your friends meet in a building whose rooms become places they imagine together. An elevator opens onto a forest performance, a floating archive, or a birthday beneath an invented sky. Augmented reality layers shared stories onto physical rooms; light, sound, surfaces, and adaptable assemblies deepen the experience.

An ordinary path remains available through the building. You can remove the glasses, find a quiet room, or leave. A responsive environment must also understand a refusal.

Some rooms change constantly. Others stay familiar for years. People need both the freedom to transform a place and the freedom to recognize it when they return.

A cup with a next life.

You return the cup near the library. It is washed, inspected, and made available again. Someone else keeps a beloved cup at home for decades.

A PROPOSED LOOP / RECOVERY IS PART OF THE DESIGN



When needed: repair, assess, recover material, and make again.

Energy and process inputs enter. Losses and residues need destinations.

The shared service includes cleaning, collection, repair, transport, and eventual recovery. Its value depends on those processes working well. Durable metal alone does not guarantee a good outcome. [1]

Public design libraries hold instructions, compatible connections, and lessons from earlier failures. Fabrication might involve printing, machining, forming, or reusing an intact part.

Care, repair, reuse, and remaking can give an object many useful lives. Energy helps materials take new forms; losses still need to be counted. The aim is to keep useful possibilities available across generations.



06 / ARCHITECTURE WITH A FUTURE

A building's next life.

A pavilion is being taken apart. Robots lift its members into a material yard, where each part is inspected for possible use elsewhere. Its history matters: what it carried, how it weathered, what was repaired.

Buildings were designed with their later lives in mind. Connections are accessible. Services can be replaced. Useful components have somewhere to go when a room changes. A shared library of parts supports many architectures.

Recoverability has limits. Structural reuse needs assessment; making more robots and buildings at the same time can tie up additional material. Circulation does not make expansion limitless. [2, 3] Living systems need care of their own. Reusing steel does not restore a watershed.

Freedom includes preserving the capacity to change our surroundings again.

The machines are ready. Are we?

The neighborhood proposes turning a square into a wetland. Children want floating paths. An artist imagines mist and light. Someone worries about nesting birds. An older resident would lose the place where she meets her friends.

The machines could begin quickly. Agreement takes longer.

Greater ability to build also gives someone greater ability to erase a place, exhaust shared capacity, or impose a vision. Technical capability cannot settle who may authorize a change. Some experiments can begin small; some consequences cannot be undone by rearranging materials.

People still disagree, seek recognition, and enjoy winning. There are fierce games, rival festivals, and demanding competitions. Their rewards cannot buy control over someone else's necessities.

This culture practices hearing objections, protecting a refusal, and repairing mistakes. Hope lives partly in noticing when a beautiful plan has harmed someone.

Come imagine it with us.

This is a worldbuilding project about possible lives. Its technical assumptions, institutions, customs, and places are open to examination. An attractive picture is the beginning of that work.

01 Where would you want to spend a day?

02 What would you want to keep from your life now?

03 What would you refuse - and who might be left out?

One place to begin is a Living Garden courtyard: homes, a shared kitchen, a quiet place, a cup's return journey, and a change residents disagree about. A spatial study and an explorable scene could let the details challenge the vision.

We share the world in which our different futures have to live.

A possible world.
An open project.

This booklet introduces a worldbuilding project by Ren, developed with AI. It brings together secure existence, plural ways of living, public knowledge, and materials designed for continuing use and transformation.

The places and institutions are proposals. Broad autonomous provision is a scenario assumption. The images are generated concepts, not architectural plans or evidence that the depicted systems work.

The project develops through lived scenes, research, spatial studies, and eventual explorable worlds. Disagreement and a closer look at the details are welcome.

A FEW MATERIAL REALITIES / FURTHER READING

[1] UNEP / Single-use beverage cups and their alternatives (2021)

Life-cycle evidence: reuse, washing, returns, and local conditions matter.

[2] JRC / Reclaimed steel components for reuse (2025)

Component histories and assessment inform structural reuse.

[3] IEA / Iron and Steel Technology Roadmap (2020)

Recovery, material quality, and growing in-use stocks constrain circularity.

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